ERN SURGE

TO CULTURE DEBATE DIVISION, DELIMITATION AND DIVERSITY



NARA LOKESH

Minister for HRD; IT, Electronics & Communication; RTG, Andhra Pradesh

"Every eligible voter should be on the roll. Our party, TDP, has understood its power from day one"

"What the youth is asking for is more jobs. That is the agenda my government is working on"

"Is the system perfect? Absolutely not. But is there intent to resolve issues? Yes"

tion of delimitation. Karnataka minister Santosh S. Lad said the state's caste census was nearing completion, while BJP leader Arvind Bellad backed OBC reservation. Andhra Pradesh minister Nara Lokesh defended the Election Commission's handling of electoral roll revision, while former chief election commissioner O.P. Rawat and former election commissioner Ashok Lavasa debated public trust in the poll panel. AIMIM president Asaduddin Owaisi spoke about constitutional secularism, while Telangana deputy chief minister Bhatti Vikramarka Mallu appealed to former Congress leaders who now head their own parties or are in the BJP to return to the Grand Old Party. Delimitation emerged as a major concern, with Congress Rajya Sabha MP from Kerala, Jebi Mather, arguing that southern states should not lose political representation for successfully handling population growth. Andhra Pradesh highlighted its investment push, with proposals worth Rs 14 lakh crore approved over two years.

The following pages offer a glimpse of the enlightening insights from those conversations. ■

—M.G. Arun